

Ethics of the platform.

Social media and other media networks have gotten more transparent in recent times. Their unique version of advertising and running online services has been a game changer. This is especially true during the political wave that hit the country recently. The idea caught on with the parties who were only too happy to use this medium for propagating their values. This is both a good and dangerous thing.

Handling the news with sensitivity becomes vital as several parties showed keen interest in using this for promoting a candidate. As far as the ethics of such a platform go; it is essential that a clear disclosure procedure is kept in place. A glitch in the process could be the fastest medium for malicious information to be spread beyond control.

It is for this reason perhaps that TikTok allows its users to upload only 15-second video clips with sound bites, songs, and effects for added effects. It has already surpassed the number of other social media users such as Snapchat and Twitter. Its hilarious reach has led it to achieve a milestone of 1 billion downloads, getting more popular than the Apple App Store, Facebook and Instagram.

Similarly like many good things, there is also a wave of uncertainty regarding online privacy; especially with regard to child safety. It has become a “hunting ground” for child predators, who communicate with ease with several children via TikTok’s internal messaging system. While the issues don’t end here, there were privacy concerns with the app itself. It has been reported that TikTok’s parent company ByteDance agreed to pay the Federal Trade Commission a \$5.7 million settlement, responding to allegations that TikTok has been illegally making its collections of some private information regarding children, using the app. 